



MUMBAI
POLICE
DURING 26/11:
RAGHU RAMAN
(BELOW)



DELHI | Grid Expectations

One of the biggest security loopholes in the horror that was 26/11 was the inability of intelligence agencies to piece together available intelligence and issue a warning of a clear and present danger about to hit the city. This month, the Home Ministry began to set up a National Intelligence Grid, (Natgrid) which will be the single largest use of technology to tackle terror threats. The Natgrid will be a giant national security database of comprehensive intelligence portraits made by fusing information collected from phone and income tax records as well as airport and immigration details of certain individuals. The secure database will be eventually be accessed by several Central agencies including the CBI, Intelligence Bureau and the R&AW. Like the National Identity Card project headed by former Infosys CEO Nandan Nilekani, the Natgrid is headed by Raghu Raman, former CEO of the Mahindra Special Services Group. It has a two-year mandate to get going. A proposal pending cabinet approval envisages the Natgrid eventually being merged with the Multi-Agency Centre, which coordinates intelligence-sharing with 23 agencies. The Natgrid will become an umbrella organisation with operational and investigative wings. It could be India's Big Brother of counter-terrorism.

by Sandeep Unnithan

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years is the
time given to
the National
Intelligence
Grid to
become
operational.